SHADES OF SAFFRON

The BJP has declared 445 Lok Sabha candidates so far, its biggest contingent yet. But casting the net so wide comes with consequences—a third of them are not even a decade-old in the party. Add to that the clutch of ex-royals, ex-bureaucrats, actors and celebrities, and the saffron party resembles what one insider called a "rainbow coalition". What this does to the party's essence is a question for tomorrow. Right now, Modi and Co. are bent on using every resource available to ensure the conquest of India is complete

BABUS-TURNED-NETAS



UJJWAL NIKAM

USP: Former public prosecutor in high-profile cases such as 26/11 attacks, 1993 Mumbai blasts

Constituency Mumbai North-East, Maharashtra



ABHIJIT GANGOPADHYAY

USP: Controversial Calcutta High Court judge resigns to join the BJP

Constituency Tamluk, West Bengal



PARAMPAL KAUR SIDHU

USP: Ex-IAS, daughter-in-law of Akali Dal No. 2, Sikandar Singh Maluka

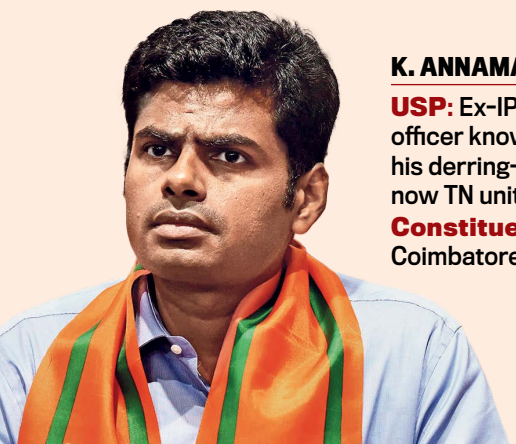
Constituency Bathinda



TARANJIT SINGH SANDHU

USP: Ex-ambassador to the US, belongs to Akali Dal founder Teja Singh Samundri's family

Constituency Amritsar



K. ANNAMALAI

USP: Ex-IPS officer known for his derring-do, now TN unit chief

Constituency Coimbatore

THE ROYAL TOUCH



PRENEET KAUR

USP: Ex-CM Amarinder Singh's wife, former Cong. MP and Patiala royalty shifts sides

Constituency Patiala, Punjab



MALAVIKA KESHARI DEO

USP: Wife of former BJD MP Arka Keshari Deo and Kalahandi blue blood

Constituency Kalahandi, Odisha



YADUVEER KRISHNADATTA C. WADIYAR

USP: Mysore royal family scion and the '27th king' makes first foray in politics

Constituency Mysuru, Karnataka



C. UDAYANRAJE BHOSALE

USP: The 13th 'direct descendant' of Shivaji maharaj is looking to avenge 2019 bypoll loss

Constituency Satara, Maharashtra



MAHIMA KUMARI

USP: Mewar family royal and wife of Nathdwara MLA Vishvaraj Mewar talks of a "1,400-year family connection"

Constituency Rajsamand, Rajasthan

INDIA INC.



NAVEEN JINDAL

USP: Ex-Congress MP, Coalgate accused gets ticket days after joining

Constituency Kurukshetra, Haryana

